PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Christopher Zorn

November 6, 2026

Read the Fine Print

INFORMATION GOOGLE COLLECTS

We want you to understand the types of information we collect as you use our services

We collect information to provide better services to all our users — from figuring out basic stuff like which language you speak, to more complex things like which ads you'll find most useful, the people who matter most to you online, or which YouTube videos you might like. The information Google collects, and how that information is used, depends on how you use our services and how you manage your privacy controls.

When you're not signed in to a Google Account, we store the information we collect with unique identifiers tied to the browser, application, or device you're using. This allows us to do things like maintain your preferences across browsing sessions, such as your preferred language or whether to show you more relevant search results or ads based on your activity.

When you're signed in, we also collect information that we store with your Google Account, which we treat as personal information.

INFORMATION GOOGLE COLLECTS

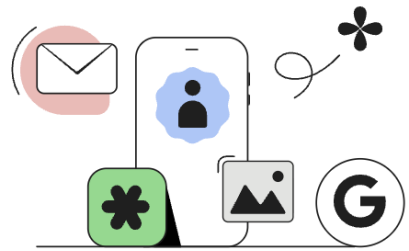
We want you to understand the types of information we collect as you use our services

We collect information to provide better services to all our users — from figuring out basic stuff like which language you speak, to more complex things like which ads you'll find most useful, the people who matter most to you online, or which YouTube videos you might like. The information Google collects, and how that information is used, depends on how you use our services and how you manage your privacy controls.

ads you'll find most useful

For example, if you watch videos

Things you create or provide to us



When you create a Google Account, you provide us with personal information that includes your name and a password. You can also choose to add a phone number or payment information to your account. Even if you aren't signed in to a Google Account, you might choose to provide us with information — like an email address to communicate with Google or receive updates about our services.

We also collect the content you create, upload, or receive from others when using our services. This includes things like email you write and receive, photos and videos you save, docs and spreadsheets you create, and comments you make on YouTube videos.

Your apps, browsers & devices



We collect information about the apps, browsers, and devices you use to access Google services, which helps us provide features like automatic product updates and dimming your screen if your battery runs low.

The information we collect includes unique identifiers, browser type and settings, device type and settings, operating system, mobile network information including carrier name and phone number, and application version number. We also collect information about the interaction of your apps, browsers, and devices with our services, including IP address, crash reports, system activity, and the date, time, and referrer URL of your request.

We collect this information when a Google service on your device contacts our servers — for example, when you install an app from the Play Store or when a service checks for automatic updates. If you're using an Android device with Google apps, your device periodically contacts Google servers to provide information about your device and connection to our services. This information includes things like your device type and carrier name, crash reports, which apps you've installed, and, depending on your device settings, other information about how you're using your Android device.

Your activity

We collect information about your activity in our services, which we use to do things like recommend a YouTube video you might like. The activity information we collect may include:

- Terms you search for
- Videos you watch
- Views and interactions with content and ads
- Voice and audio information
- Purchase activity
- People with whom you communicate or share content
- Activity on third-party sites and apps that use our services
- Chrome browsing history you've synced with your Google Account

If you use our services to make and receive calls or send and receive messages , we may collect call and message log information like your phone number, calling-party number, receiving-party number, forwarding numbers, sender and recipient email address, time and date of calls and messages, duration of calls, routing information, and types and volumes of calls and messages.

Your location information

We collect location information when you use our services, which helps us offer features like driving directions, search results for things near you, and ads based on your location.

Depending on the products you're using and settings you choose, Google may use different types of location information to help make some services and products you use more helpful. These include:

- GPS and other sensor data from your device
- IP address
- Activity on Google services , such as from your searches or places you label like home or work
- Information about things near your device , such as Wi-Fi access points, cell towers, and Bluetooth-enabled devices

The types of location data we collect and how long we store it depend in part on your device and account settings. For example, you can turn your Android device's location on or off using the device's settings app. You can also turn on Timeline if you want to create a private map of where you go with your signed-in devices. And if your Web & App Activity setting is enabled, your searches and other activity from Google services, which may also include location information, is saved to your Google Account. Learn more about how we use location information.

In some circumstances, Google also collects information about you from publicly accessible sources. For example, if your name appears in your local newspaper, Google's Search engine may index that article and display it to other people if they search for your name. We may also collect information about you from trusted partners, such as directory services who provide us with business information to be displayed on Google's services, marketing partners who provide us with information about potential customers of our business services, and security partners who provide us with information to protect against abuse. We also receive information from partners to provide advertising and research services on their behalf.

We use various technologies to collect and store information, including cookies, pixel tags, local storage, such as browser web storage or application data caches, databases, and server logs.

For What Purposes Does Amazon Use Your Personal Information?

We use your personal information to operate, provide, develop, and improve the products and services that we offer our customers. These purposes include:

- **Purchase and delivery of products and services.** We use your personal information to take and handle orders, deliver products and services, process payments, and communicate with you about orders, products and services, and promotional offers.
- **Provide, troubleshoot, and improve Amazon Services.** We use your personal information to provide functionality, analyze performance, fix errors, and improve the usability and effectiveness of the Amazon Services.
- **Recommendations and personalization.** We use your personal information to recommend features, products, and services that might be of interest to you, identify your preferences, and personalize your experience with Amazon Services.
- **Provide voice, image and camera services.** When you use our voice, image and camera services, we use your voice input, images, videos, and other personal information to respond to your requests, provide the requested service to you, and improve our services. You can read more about Alexa, Echo Devices, and Your Privacy.

Use: Amazon

- **Comply with legal obligations.** In certain cases, we collect and use your personal information to comply with laws. For instance, we collect from sellers information regarding place of establishment and bank account information for identity verification and other purposes.
- **Communicate with you.** We use your personal information to communicate with you in relation to Amazon Services via different channels (for example, by phone, email, chat).
- **Advertising.** We use your personal information to display interest-based ads for features, products, and services that might be of interest to you. We do not use information that personally identifies you to display interest-based ads. To learn more, please read our Interest-Based Ads notice.
- **Fraud Prevention and Credit Risks.** We use personal information to prevent and detect fraud and abuse in order to protect the security of our customers, Amazon, and others. We may also use scoring methods to assess and manage credit risks.

Retention: TikTok

TikTok

- Information We Collect
- How We Use Your Information
- How We Share Your Information
- Your Rights and Choices
- **Data Security and Retention**
- Children and Teens
- Other Rights
- Privacy Policy Updates
- Contact Us

Data Security and Retention

We use reasonable measures to help protect information from loss, theft, misuse, unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or destruction. You should understand that no data storage system or transmission of data over the Internet or any other public network can be guaranteed to be 100 percent secure. Please note that information collected by third parties may not have the same security protections as information you submit to us, and we are not responsible for protecting the security of such information.

We retain information for as long as necessary to provide the Services and for the other purposes set out in this Privacy Policy. We also retain information when necessary to comply with contractual and legal obligations, when we have a legitimate business interest to do so (such as improving and developing the Services, and enhancing its safety, security and stability), and for the exercise or defense of legal claims.

The retention periods are different depending on different criteria, such as the type of information and the purposes for which we use the information. For example, when we process your information such as your account registration information to provide you with the Services, we keep this information for as long as you have an account, subject to your updates of such information. If you violate our Terms of Service ↗, Community Guidelines ↗, or other conditions or policies, we may remove you from the Services immediately, but may keep information about you to process the violation.

Subject to applicable laws, including Executive Order 14352 and any compliance obligations thereunder, we may transmit your information outside of the United States, for purposes of sharing with recipients as described in this Privacy Policy.

Retention: TikTok



NATIONAL ARCHIVES

FEDERAL REGISTER

The Daily Journal of the United States Government

Presidential Document

Saving TikTok While Protecting National Security

A Presidential Document by the Executive Office of the President on 09/30/2025

PUBLISHED DOCUMENT: 2025-19139 (90 FR 47219)

PDF

Document Details

Executive Order Details

Table of Contents

Public Comments

Regulations.gov

(printed page 47219)

Executive Order 14352 of September 25, 2025

Saving TikTok While Protecting National Security

By the authority vested in me as President by the Constitution and the laws of the United States of America, it is hereby ordered:

Section 1 . *Background.* The Protecting Americans from Foreign Adversary Controlled Applications Act (the "Act") (Public Law 118-50, Div. H) regulates "foreign adversary controlled applications," specifically those operated by TikTok and any other subsidiary of its China-based parent company, ByteDance Ltd., on national security grounds.

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

How do we share information with third parties?



Highlights

We share certain information with:

- Advertisers who show ads on our Products
- Businesses we hire to market our Products for us
- Businesses we hire to do things like offer customer service or conduct surveys
- Researchers who use it to do things like innovate, advance technology, or improve people's safety

We don't sell your information, and we never will.

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

We don't sell any of your information to anyone, and we never will. We also require **partners** and other **third parties** to follow rules about how they can and cannot use and disclose the information we provide.

Here's more detail about who we share information with:

Partners

- Advertisers and Audience Network publishers
- Partners who use our analytics services
- Partners who offer goods or services on our Products and commerce services platforms
- Integrated partners

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

Advertisers and Audience Network publishers

Advertisers

We provide advertisers with reports about the number and kinds of people who see and engage with their ads and commercial content. These reports include information about the general demographics and interests of people who engaged with an advertiser's ad or commercial content. Then advertisers can better understand their audience. See an example.

Meta also provides advertisers and their vendors with information about:

- Ads and commercial content people engaged with, if any
- When people engaged with ads and commercial content
- Where that ad or commercial content was shown (for example, on Instagram, or on Facebook)

We also confirm which ads or commercial content you viewed that led you to take an action with an advertiser, such as downloading an advertiser's app. But we don't share information with these advertisers and their vendors that by itself can be used to contact or identify you, such as your name or email address, unless you give us permission.

Audience Network publishers and their vendors

Meta Audience Network lets advertisers place ads with us that will be published on other apps and websites outside of Meta.

To help show you ads on their apps and websites, we share information with publishers who use Audience Network, as well as vendors who facilitate that use. For example, we share:

- How many people see and engage with ads on publisher apps
- Information related to or in response to a publisher's request to serve an ad on its app.

But we don't share information with these publishers and their vendors that by itself can be used to contact or identify you, such as your name or email address, unless you give us permission.

General demographics and interests

For example, a bike shop creates a Page on Facebook and wants to place an ad to reach an audience of people in Atlanta interested in cycling. We determine whether someone fits in this audience based on, for example, whether they liked a Page about bikes. Then people in that audience could see the bike shop's ad.

You can see the "interests" assigned to you in your Ad preferences and remove them if you want.

The bike shop can then see reports showing aggregated statistics about the audience seeing their ads and how their ads are performing. The reports would show statistics to the advertiser that, for example, most of the people who saw or clicked on their ad:

- Were women
- Were between the ages of 25 and 34
- Clicked on the ad from their phone

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

Partners who use our analytics services

People rely on our **Products**, like business accounts, professional tools and Facebook Pages, to run and promote their businesses. Businesses use our analytics services to understand more about how people are using their content, features, products and services.

To provide these services, we use the **information we collect** about you. We put this information into aggregate reports so that partners can see how well their content, features, products and services are performing and are able to understand things like users' experience with such content, products and services.

These reports aggregate information like:

- How many people interacted with our partners' content, products or services
- The **general demographics and interests** of the people who interacted with it
- How people use our partners' products and services to connect to Meta Products and the performance of their connection and networks

Advertisers also receive other information. **Read our Policy** about how we share information with advertisers.

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

Vendors

- Measurement vendors
- Marketing vendors

Service providers

- Service providers

Third parties

- External researchers
- AI integrations

Other third parties

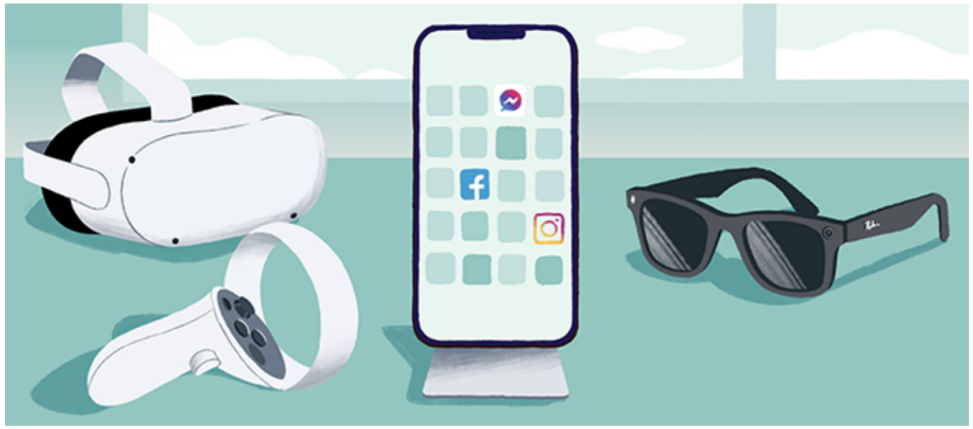
We also share information with other **third parties** in response to legal requests, to comply with applicable law or to prevent harm. **Read the Policy**.

And if we sell or transfer all or part of our business to someone else, in some cases we'll give the new owner your information as part of that transaction, but only as the law allows.

Transfer: Instagram (Meta)

How do the Meta Companies work together?

Highlights



We are part of the **Meta Companies** that provide Meta Company Products. **Meta Company Products** include all the **Meta Products** covered by this Policy, plus other products like WhatsApp and more.

We share information we collect, infrastructure, systems and technology with the other Meta Companies. **Learn more** about how we transfer information to other countries.

We also process information that we receive about you from other Meta Companies, according to their terms and policies and as permitted by applicable law. In some cases, Meta acts as a **service provider** for other Meta Companies. We act on their behalf and in accordance with their instructions and terms.

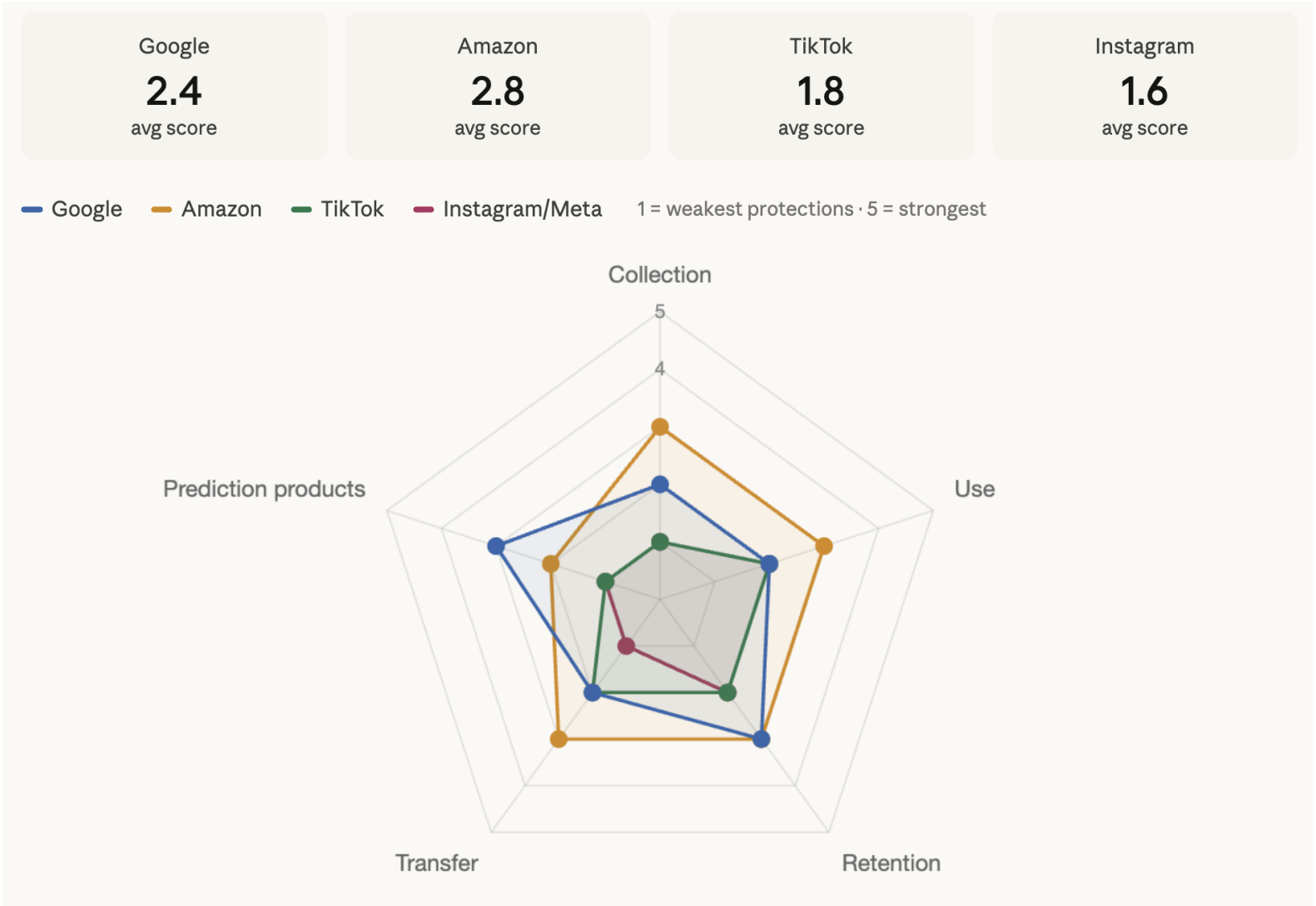
Why we share across the Meta Companies

Meta Products share information with other Meta Companies:

- To promote safety, security and integrity and comply with applicable laws
- To personalize offers, ads and other sponsored or commercial content
- To develop, provide and personalize features and integrations
- To understand how people use and interact with Meta Company Products

See some examples of why we share.

What Claude Thinks



More of What Claude Thinks

Platform privacy scores: surveillance capitalism framework

Scores reflect degree of user protection (5 = strongest, 1 = weakest) across five dimensions. Qualitative assessments drawn from each platform's current privacy policies and documented practices.

Dimension	Google	Amazon	TikTok	Instagram / Meta
Collection *How much behavioral surplus is captured?*	2/5 Vast — cross-service behavioral data, third-party tracking	3/5 Commerce-focused but includes Alexa, health data, inferences	1/5 Most expansive: biometric, pre-upload, device-level, AI interactions	1/5 Cross-platform, off-platform pixel, non-user profiles, AI chats
Use *Confined to service, or behavioral profiling for third parties?*	2/5 Ad targeting, but limits sensitive category use and Gmail/Drive profiling	3/5 Commerce-centric; shares only non-identifying data for ad measurement	2/5 Off-platform ad targeting added 2026; AI interaction data now collected	2/5 Core business is behavioral ad targeting; AI chat data now included
Retention *How long, in what form, under user control?*	4/5 Granular auto-delete options (3/18/36 mo.), manual deletion, export	3/5 "As long as needed" language; deletion requests processed, ~24 days	2/5 Purpose-based retention; "legitimate business interest" carve-out is broad	2/5 30–90 day deletion pipeline; backups, legal holds, anonymized data persist
Transfer *Who else gets the data, under what constraints?*	2/5 No direct-ID sharing with advertisers; but wide ad partner ecosystem	3/5 Does not sell data; third-party ad services get non-identifying info only	2/5 ByteDance / Chinese law exposure; broad service-provider sharing	1/5 Broad Meta-family sharing; advertiser ecosystem; €1.2B GDPR fine 2023
Prediction products *Behavioral predictions sold in futures markets?*	3/5 Invented the model; regulatory scrutiny + opt-outs temper worst practices	2/5 Amazon DSP sells purchase-intent targeting; Alexa deepens surplus extraction	1/5 Hyper-granular behavioral inference; few U.S. opt-out constraints	1/5 98% of revenue from behavioral ad targeting; most developed surveillance capitalism model
Overall *Relative user protection level*	13/25 Moderate — strong retention controls offset massive collection footprint	14/25 Best of four — commerce focus limits worst profiling practices	8/25 Weak — breadth of collection + geopolitical transfer risk + no opt-outs	7/25 Weakest — surveillance capitalism in its most developed form

Privacy Policy Links

- Google: https://policies.google.com/privacy?hl=en-US
- Amazon: https://www.amazon.com/gp/help/customer/display.html?nodeId=GX7NJQ4ZB8MHFRNJ
- TikTok: https://www.tiktok.com/legal/page/us/privacy-policy/en
- Meta: https://privacycenter.instagram.com/policy

Claude (Sonnet 4.6) prompt

```
Address the issue of privacy and surveillance in AI, against a background of Shoshana Zuboff's
"Surveillance Capitalism" ideas. Consider four general / conceptual areas of concern around
AI / platforms and data privacy: Collection, Use, Retention, and Transfer. "Collection" goes to
what data are collected on platform users, "Use" is about how those data are used, "Retention"
is about how (how long, in what form, etc.) the platform retains the user data, and "Transfer"
centers concerns about platforms transferring user data to third-parties. In general, platforms
that (a) collect less data / ideally only the data they need (i.e., minimize Zuboff's "behavioral
surplus"), (b) allow users to "opt out" of data collection / use / retention / transfer, and/or (c)
allow users to control the extent of their data's collection / use / retention / transfer. Those
that collect less data and allow more control are better -- from a privacy / surveillance
perspective -- than those that are not.

Consider the privacy policies of each of four large online platforms:

https://policies.google.com/privacy?hl=en-US

https://www.amazon.com/gp/help/customer/display.html?nodeId=GX7NJQ4ZB8MHFRNJ

https://www.tiktok.com/legal/page/us/privacy-policy/en

https://privacycenter.instagram.com/policy

Assess each of those four platforms in terms of its degree of user protections around data
collection, use, retention, and transfer, and compare among them. In addition, for each platform
also include a measure of the extent to which it engages in generating and selling "prediction
products": Behavioral predictions derived from user data that are sold in prediction futures markets
to other corporations and entities. Include a summary visualization that scores each platform on
each of the four dimensions + the "prediction products" metric, on a 1 (= weakest user protections)
to 5 (= strongest user protections) scale.
```